# Book Nerd Privacy

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## Who Can See Your Information

Your books and settings are stored in your own cloud account. Other Book Nerd users cannot see them, except for the small part you choose to share with friends, which is described on the next page.

The administrator of Book Nerd has a higher level of access to the database and can see what is saved there. This is exactly what the administrator can see:

- Your email address, and when you created your account and last signed in
- Your name, profile photo and birthday (month and day only), if you added them
- Every book in your library, including its title, author, status and rating, and any review, notes or quotes you wrote
- Your reading challenge, badges and settings, and the date you confirmed you had read this page
- Your friends, friend requests, blocked people, and the books you recommended or were sent
- Reports you send, and reports sent about you
- If you turn on Let Others Find Me, a directory entry with your first name and a scrambled code made from your email address

> This is what the administrator can never see: **your password**. Passwords are handled by Google and are not visible to anyone.

## Friends and Sharing

**Friends are optional.** You need an account to use them. Nothing is shared with anyone until you accept a friend request, or someone accepts yours.

**Let Others Find Me** is off until you turn it on. When it is on, a person who types your exact email address can find you and send a friend request. They see only your first name. Book Nerd keeps a scrambled code of your email address in its directory, not the address itself. Before you can turn it on, you confirm your email address by tapping a link that Google (Firebase) sends you.

**What a friend can see:** your first name and photo, the books you are currently reading, and the books you have finished, with the cover, title, author and your star rating.

**What a friend cannot see:** your To Read list, reviews, notes, quotes, birthday, email address, stats, badges and reading challenge.

**Recommendations.** When you send a book to a friend, they receive its title, author, cover, your first name, and your rating if you gave one. Up to five can wait for a friend at once. Your friend can add the book to their To Read list or dismiss it, and you are not told which.

**Removing, blocking and reporting.** Removing a friend ends the sharing in both directions. Blocking does the same, and also stops that person from finding you or sending you requests. Reporting sends a short note to the administrator. The other person is never told about any of these.

## Where Your Information Is Kept

**If you don't create an account,** everything you add stays on your own device. Nothing is sent to Book Nerd's cloud.

**If you create an account,** a copy of your information is kept in the cloud so your books can follow you from device to device. The cloud is run by Google (Firebase), and the information is stored in the United States.

**Age.** Book Nerd is for people 13 and older. When you set up Book Nerd, it asks for your birthday once, to check your age on your own device. Book Nerd keeps the month and day for a birthday card and never keeps the year. If you are under 13, Book Nerd cannot be set up for you, and nothing you entered is kept.

Book Nerd has no ads, and it doesn't include analytics or tracking tools.

## Other Services That See Part of What You Do

To find and show book details, Book Nerd asks a few outside services. Your device sends them only what they need to find the book, such as a title or author you typed, or the ISBN of a barcode you scanned. It does not send your name, email or account details.

- **Open Library and Google Books** receive your searches and ISBNs, and provide book details and covers.
- **Wikipedia** receives an author's name when you open that author's page.
- **Amazon** is visited only if you tap the link to buy a book.
- **GitHub, Google and jsDelivr** deliver Book Nerd's pages and some of its tools, including the barcode scanner and page reader.

**Google reCAPTCHA**, through Firebase App Check, checks that requests to your cloud data come from the real Book Nerd page. To do this it may collect information about your device and browser. Google's Privacy Policy and Terms of Service apply.

Like any website, these services can see your device's internet address when your device connects to them. Scanning uses your camera on your device. Photos of pages are read on your

device and are not uploaded.

## Your Choices

**Turn Off Let Others Find Me.** On the Profile page, open Let Others Find Me and choose Turn Off. New people can no longer find you. Your friends stay your friends.

**Remove or Block a Friend.** Open your friend's page and choose Friend Options. You can also see everyone you have blocked, and unblock them, under Blocked People on the Profile page.

**Delete Your Cloud Data.** On the Profile page, open Cloud Sync and choose Delete My Cloud Data. After you enter your password, Book Nerd erases your books, name, photo, birthday, settings, friends, requests, blocked people, directory entry and shared reading list from the cloud, and deletes your sign-in account, which includes your email address. Your books stay on your devices. Recommendations you already sent stay in your friends' lists until they dismiss them, and reports you sent stay with the administrator.

**Stop Saving on One Device.** Choose Unlink This Phone in the same place. Your books stay on that device and in the cloud.

**Keep Your Own Copy.** Save Backup creates a file of your books on your device, and Restore reads it back.

**Forgot Your Password?** Choose Forgot Password? when you sign in, and a reset link is sent to your email.

**No Account?** Everything stays on your device. Clearing the site's data from your browser, or deleting the app, removes it.

## Questions

If you have a question about this page or need help with your account, email admin@booknerd.online.